

General

The following is intended to serve as a general Guide to ranged combat and how it works.

Units in Conflict of Nations can in general be separated into two categories: "Ranged" and "Melee".

Ranged units, as the name already implies, have an attack range that is detailed in their unit description and also visible as a white circle when selecting the unit itself. While melee units are forced to close the gap between themselves and the stack.

It is worth noting that ranged attacks *a/ways* use the attack value of the unit. Defense values only matter when a unit is fighting in melee.

Examples for Ranged Units would be:

- Any ship (except ofc carriers)
- Towed Artillery/Mobile Artillery/Multiple Rocket Launcher
- Motorized Infantry at Lvl 6

Examples for Melee Units:

- Main Battle Tanks
- Infantry

Importance of ranged combat

It derives its importance from enabling units to deal damage without receiving any in return as well as the added flexibility of attacking from a distance.

Because of that, they are able to continuously deal damage to the enemy, compared to units that have to fight in melee and take damage even from just attacking because of the defensive stats of a unit and so eventually have to leave the frontline to go and heal.

On top of that, having ranged attacks means that the unit can cover (ofc depending on its range) a much larger area and has an easier time engaging enemy units than a stack that fights in melee would. It's also worth keeping in mind that attacking from range means that your unit is not locked in combat and only needs to be stationary for the 1-2 seconds it takes to actually "fire" the shot.

All of this makes artillery essentially the bane of all ground units with the only downside of not dealing any damage to anything else. This can be crucial when having to fight multiple opponents or just being heavily outnumbered in general, because if you lose less than them you will be able to eventually win the fight.

How to use ranged units

By far the biggest downside ranged units, especially artillery, have is that they require you to be active to make the most use of them.

Let's take for example a stack of 10 Multiple Rocket Launchers (MRL), it doesn't matter if the opposing stack has 10, 100 or 1000 HP; as long as you're active enough to hit the enemy and then move the stack away they won't stand a chance, this, however, requires you to give the order each time after they shot (1h) as well as keeping an eye in general on that area because once the MRLs are caught they're basically dead.

Because of this inherent weakness some people use other units ranging from just simple Infantry to Armored Fighting Vehicles (AFV) or even Main Battle Tanks (MBT) to compensate for their lack of activity, the idea is that there is one (or maybe multiple) stacks acting as a blockade of sorts; the enemy stack heads towards your MRLs, encounters your "Block" on the way there and now spends a (hopefully) good amount of time fighting it, time which your MRL can also use to deal more damage.

What is "Hit and Run"

"Hit and Run" is something you might've already seen mentioned from time to time. There are two versions of how the term is used.

The more general "Hit an enemy and instead of standing still drive away until you have reloaded".

And a slightly different one that refers more to artillery vs artillery and avoiding getting hit back by the enemy.

The first one ties into what I already mentioned earlier in "How to use Ranged Units"; it refers to moving your artillery so, that, in combination with the speed penalty on enemy terrain, your opponent never reaches your artillery because after each hit you move it back far enough to not get caught, you "Hit" the enemy stack and then "Run" away to reposition.

In artillery vs artillery combat, it only is a thing when both sides have the same range. It works on the premise that Artillery takes about 1-3 minutes to fire on an enemy in range/fire back on a hostile Artillery that is hitting them. It works much like the first version, just with the difference that now you're on a much closer timer to move your artillery away because otherwise, the other guy hits you back (It's worth reiterating

that when using ranged attacks, a unit always uses its attack value, their defense values only matter when getting caught in melee).



Units that go well with artillery

Artillery alone is extremely vulnerable, this is why you should use it in combination with other units e.g.:

Anti-Air:

As you might have noticed artillery is only good against Ground Units, which means that if you want your stack to survive throughout the game you need to prepare defenses against aircraft as soon as you're able to. Mobile Anti-Air (MAA) or SAMs work really well, especially SAMs are something I would recommend because of the prevalence of Strike Fighters (SF) and/or Cruise Missiles (CM). There are some differences between the different Anti-Air units:

- Mobile Anti Air (MAA): low range (26-50), moderate damage to Jets (fixed-wing. high against Helis (rotary-wing) and low against Missiles. They serve best as early Anti-Air or to defend against Helis specifically
- SAM: high range (75-100), high damage to Jets, no damage to helis and moderate damage to missiles
- Elite Railgun: high range (75-100), moderate damage to all, however it is limited and can easily suffer from terrain penalties
- Air Superiority Fighter (ASF): very fast with 16 speed, incredibly versatile, better protection against Helis than MAA

To keep your units safe from airborne threats you ideally want to stack them with the unit you're trying to protect and not have them as a separate stack. The reason behind this is that Ranged AA Defense is easily disabled while the Point Defense will always be active. For more details on how AA works see my other [Doc](#).

Out of all the listed options, especially SAMs and ASF are important.

SAMs primarily because both SF and CM spam are fairly common strategies and they do a good job at countering both, they are however a more reactive defense against aircraft and fairly limited in their mobility even with the air assault upgrade later on. So they are almost forced to wait for the enemy to come at them.

ASF are absolutely vital since they are both really early possible to get and are very useful. With a speed of 16 making them the fastest aircraft by a pretty large margin, this allows them to actively hunt for enemy aircraft and be very flexible about their location, their incredible speed plays a major role in how effective they are against Helis, with them being twice as fast. On top of that, they are still able to target ground units which makes them really useful for catching lone infantry trying to run through somewhere.

Scouting:

Units with the “Scout” ability are able to determine the exact unit composition of a stack, this can prove quite useful if you have to decide between multiple radar contacts and which one to actually target.

- UAV: cheap, can fly, becomes stealth at later levels,
- Recon Vehicle: early available, gets the ability to air assault later on
- Specops: stealth from Lvl 1 (despite being stealth they still have a Heli signature during air assaults), air assault ability from Lvl 1, actually capable of combat

Radar:

Even if you don't have to worry about aircraft killing your precious artillery, having a radar is essential for ranged units. Because while your artillery (or ship) has quite some range, you still need to actually give it a target to maximize effectiveness and waiting for the enemy to enter your provinces or scouting with aircraft is not always a very viable solution. That is where radars, to be more precise; Ground Radar or AWACS enter the field. While yes, they don't tell you the exact unit composition, you only need a radar dot to be able to hit a stack.

- Ground Radar: high ground signature, high air signature, high naval signature
after Lvl 3: low ground signature, high air signature, high naval signature
- AWACS: high ground signature, high air signature, high naval signature
after Lvl 4: high ground signature, low air signature, high naval signature
- NPA: low naval signatures, sonar signatures

In general, all of this comes down to: Ground Radar can detect Infantry but not high-level aircraft or Helis, while AWACS can't detect Infantry but instead detects high-level aircraft or helis.

Difference between using Scouts and Radar:

People often make the mistake and put Radars and units that have the ability to identify the enemy stacks e.g.: UAV, Special Forces into the same category, however that is wrong; they do have similar yet different roles. While both serve the purpose of giving you more Intel about the enemy, they couldn't be any more different, in fact, they do have an incredible synergy. The purpose of Radar is to cover a fairly large area and give you vague Intel information about it in the form of radar dots. Scouts cover an incredibly small area but in return for that, they do give you the exact unit composition. Combining both means that the radar gives you the position of stacks in

the form of these radar dots, and then you can send your scouts to identify the exact composition of it.

Infantry

In order to conquer land, you need to have some Infantry. You get a few at the start, but it's usually not enough to enable you to conquer at a good speed. Here are some infos about every infantry that can be used:

- Motorized Infantry: The best for beginners, and at tier 3 (Lvl 6) it gets a ranged attack which is very effective against inactive players (not much against good opponents), it is also one of the cheaper Inf that requires fewer buildings than others
- Mechanized Infantry: More expensive, but in comparison also better suited for combat, in general, its quite a bit tougher than any of the other Infantry
- Airborne infantry: Extremely mobile, the air assault enables them to capture especially rough terrain like mountains and jungles quite fast as they dont get slowed down by it, downside is that giving the order to air assault requires activity
- Special Forces: Capable of air assault, stealth and quite a few other abilities, this makes them exceptionally good at recon and assassinating eg.: aircraft at their airfield or support units
- Naval Infantry: Initially their ability to embark/disembark without the need for a harbor made them especially good at taking small islands that didnt have on, to prepare for invasions; however nowadays every island has a harbor so they have become rather useless
- National Guard: In terms of combat prowess probably the by far weakest Infantry, they are however quite cheap and fast produced, both traits that make them really useful for capturing territories

One major mistake that seems to be pretty common is to put Infantry into your stack of Artillery and then have that combo move through enemy provinces. It's a mistake because it

- 1) Gives your enemy free Intel on what units you have in your stack and what level they are
- 2) It provides the enemy a visible target to attack, if you keep it in your own territory he won't be able to spot it outside the few seconds where it actually attacks
- 3) Moving on enemy territory reduced unit movement speed to $\frac{2}{3}$ of their original value, this means that ofc enemy units will have an easier time catching you; this

penalty is also foundation of one of the major strengths of Artillery: As long as you move inside your own/allied territory the enemy won't have a chance to catch you because of said penalty.

Officers

You can choose to add (tank or infantry) officers in your artillery stacks, to boost it, even if it's rarely worth it in public games, where pretty much nobody plays artillery.

Officers have a few advantages:

- More overall durability to the stack
- Speed boost (essential when you Hit & Run) that is boosted by both tank and infantry officers
- Combat value boosts (every support unit is considered a hard target, except for towed, so tank and infantry officers don't boost the same units when it comes to combat values)

What artillery to choose?

What to choose between Multiple Rocket Launchers (MRL) and Mobile Artillery (MA)?

First things first, there is no better choice in general, you need to choose depending on the situation what unit to go for. You need to know just 2 things:

- MRL works in all situations for newbies, so this is a good choice.
- In a 1 v 1, the MRL will always win against MA.(I will explain the only exception later)

Comparison MRL and MA (assuming max Lvl)

	Multiple Rocket Launcher	Mobile Artillery
Firepower	7 / 7	5.5 / 8.0 against Soft/Hard
Range	100	85
Speed	1.3 (after Lvl 3)	1.3
HP	20	35
Airlift	After Lvl 4	After Lvl 6
Doctrines	No advantages/disadvantages	EU: +5% Soft dmg, 20% more HP East: earlier research
Building required	• Lvl 1 Arms Industry • Lvl 4 Army Base	• Lvl 1 Arms Industry • Lvl 3 Army Base
Resources used	• 2250 Supplies	• 1800 Supplies

	• 1100 Electronics • 800 Manpower • 2500 Money	• 1900 Components • 725 Manpower • 2200 Money
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When to do what

The best thing is to start with MA as it is more efficient in the early game since you can have more and earlier than MRL and the difference in range doesn't matter that much early on. Then, around day 15, you start to make more. From day 17-18, the MRL unlocks the 100 attack range and becomes way more effective than MA, that's why you should do a transition to MRL around day 15. However, if you have no resources or simply no enemy who also decides to build artillery, then you can just keep making MA. Of course, personal preference can also play a role, and having that earlier airlift MRLs offer can be quite nice to have. The last exception is if you are in a coalition and you are the one doing navy, you should directly make MRL or Towed Artillery because of the high component cost of MA.

And what about both?

There is an advanced strategy, in a 2v2, against 2 MRL players. You would have 1 player with MA and the other one with MRL. The 1st one can attack targets like cities and take damage with his big number of hp, and the other attacks back. Just keep in mind that this is not necessarily better than 2x MRL.

Towed artillery

What is it?

This is the weakest of all artilleries, the slowest (1.00), and the only one to not be a hard target. Despite that, it is the cheapest artillery and it only needs an Arms Industry level 1 and a Military Base level 2. Towed Artillery also has the highest attack values against soft targets and the lowest against Hard ones. The Eastern Doctrine offers a bonus on research and a +20% to dmg against Hard units for Towed Artillery.

How to play it?

You can't hit and run as you would an MRL or MA, you need to use air assault which allows it to be moved in helicopters (unlock Day 14): if you get rushed by a unit that is faster than you (this is 9 units out of 10). You just need to be very careful of ASF that are way faster than the helicopter in which your Towed Artillery is transported, a stack of ASF will easily kill your units. Moreover, the Towed Artillery is better in mountains, just like the other two artillery.

When to play it

You have 2 main scenarios where it is interesting:

- In the early game, if you need artillery, this is very quick to deploy

- Later, against an enemy that uses a lot of infantry, towed artillery can be quite efficient.

Fire control options

- Default: Unit only engages hostiles within range when stationary
- Hold Fire: Unit never engages enemies unless specifically ordered to do so.¹
- Return Fire: The unit only engages the enemy if attacked first.
- Aggressive: Automatically engages enemies in range, postponing all other orders until combat is resolved.²

Some General Advices

Be careful when stacking multiple units that have different ranges, units will only deal damage within their respective range so if you stack one with 50 and one with 100 range and then attack an enemy that is 100 away only the unit that has 100 range will fire. This means that you essentially wasted the attack of the unit with lower range because the cooldown for attacks is not unit specific, but for the whole stack

- Enable the visibility of connections in the settings in the bottom right corner, this helps a lot with predicting enemies as well as finding the ideal spot for your units
- As with any other unit, you need to look at what terrain you are using your artillery on. Artillery has buffs in mountains, and debuffs in forests and jungles
- Don't use artillery in melee, this means you shouldn't put it in a stack with melee units like tanks

¹ this also affects anti-air

² if a unit moves, your unit will follow it